



**Gokaraju Rangaraju Institute of Engineering and Technology**  
**(Autonomous)**

**UNIT-I : WATER TECHNOLOGY**

**Introduction:**

Water is nature's most wonderful, abundant, useful compound and is an essential without it one cannot survive.

It occupies a unique position in industries. Its most important use is as an engineering material in the *steam generation*.

Water is also used as *coolant* in power and chemical plants.

It is also used in other fields such as production of steel, rayon, paper, atomic energy, textiles, chemicals, ice and for air-conditioning, drinking, bathing, sanitary, washing, irrigation, etc.

**Occurrence:**

Water is widely distributed in nature. It has been estimated that about 75% matter on earth's surface consists of water. The body of human being consists of about 60% of water. Plants, fruits and vegetables contain 90-95% of water.

**Sources of Water:**

Different sources of water are:

1. **Surface Waters:** Rain water (purest form of natural water), River water, Lake Water, Sea water (most impure form of natural water).
2. **Underground Waters:** Spring and Well water. Underground waters have high organic impurity.

**1Q. Explain why hard water does not lather with soap? (Or) What is the cause of hardness of water? (Or) Write short notes on hardness of water. (Or) What is hardness of water due to?**

**Hardness:-**

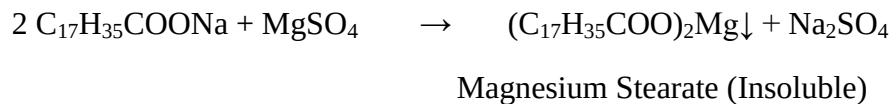
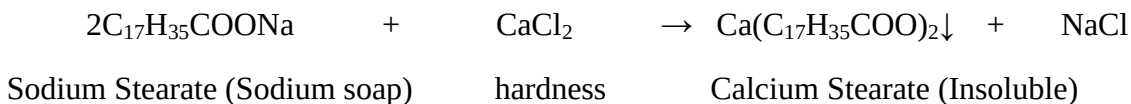
Hardness of water is a characteristic property by which water "*prevents lathering of soap*".

**Causes:**

- The hardness of water is due to presence of certain salts (mainly bicarbonates, sulphates and Chlorides) of Ca, Mg and few other heavy metal salts dissolved in water.

- A sample of hard water when treated with soap (sodium or potassium salt of higher fatty acid like oleic, palmitic or stearic) do not produce lather with soap, but on the other hand forms a white scum or precipitate.
- The precipitate is formed due to insoluble soaps of Ca and Mg.

Reactions:-



Thus the water which does not produce lather with soap solution readily is called **HARD WATER** and water which lathers easily on shaking with soap solution is called **SOFT WATER**.

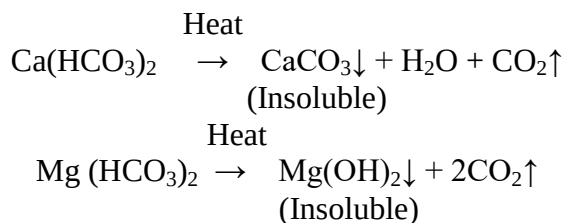
**2Q. Distinguish between temporary and permanent hardness of water? (Or) What is meant by carbonate and non-carbonate hardness of water? (JNTU)**

**Types of hardness:**

**1. Temporary or carbonate hardness:-**

- It is caused by the presence of dissolved bicarbonates of Ca, Mg and other heavy metals and carbonate of Iron.
- Temporary hardness is mostly destroyed by mere boiling of water i.e., when bicarbonates are decomposed, they yield insoluble carbonates or hydroxides, which are deposited as '*crust*' at the bottom of the vessel.

Reactions:-



**2. PERMANENT or NONCARBONATE HARDNESS:-**

- It is due to presence of chlorides and sulphates of Ca, Mg, Fe and other heavy metals.
- It is not destroyed upon boiling.

- It can be eliminated by different techniques like, Lime Soda process, Ion exchange process, Zeolite process, etc.

$$\text{Total Hardness} = \text{Temporary Hardness} + \text{Permanent Hardness.}$$

**3Q. How do you express the hardness? What are the units to express the hardness? Or How is the hardness of water expressed?**

**Equivalents of  $\text{CaCO}_3$ :-**

- The concentrations of hardness as well as non-hardness constituting ions are usually expressed in terms of equivalent amount of  $\text{CaCO}_3$ .
- The choice of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  in particular is due to its molecular weight 100 (equivalent weight=50) and it is the most insoluble salt that can be precipitated in water treatment.
- Hardness of the hardness causing salt in terms of  $\text{CaCO}_3$

The equivalents of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  =

$$= \frac{\text{Mass of hardness causing substance} \times \text{chemical equivalent of } \text{CaCO}_3 \times \text{mol. wt of } \text{CaCO}_3}{\text{Chemical equivalent or molecular Wt of hardness causing substance}}$$

$$= \frac{\text{Mass of hardness causing substance} \times 50 \times 100}{\text{Chemical equivalent or molecular Wt of hardness causing substance}}$$

**Calculation of equivalents of  $\text{CaCO}_3$ :**

| Salt/ion                                  | Molar mass | Chemical Equivalent Or Equivalent Weight | Multiplication factor for converting into equivalents of $\text{CaCO}_3$ |
|-------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$               | 162        | 81                                       | 100/162                                                                  |
| $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$               | 146        | 73                                       | 100/146                                                                  |
| $\text{CaSO}_4$                           | 136        | 68                                       | 100/136                                                                  |
| $\text{CaCl}_2$                           | 111        | 55.5                                     | 100/111                                                                  |
| $\text{MgSO}_4$                           | 120        | 60                                       | 100/120                                                                  |
| $\text{MgCl}_2$                           | 95         | 47.5                                     | 100/95                                                                   |
| $\text{CaCO}_3$                           | 100        | 50                                       | 100/100                                                                  |
| $\text{MgCO}_3$                           | 84         | 42                                       | 100/84                                                                   |
| $\text{CO}_2$                             | 44         | 22                                       | 100/44                                                                   |
| $\text{Ca}(\text{NO}_3)_2$                | 164        | 82                                       | 100/164                                                                  |
| $\text{Mg}(\text{NO}_3)_2$                | 148        | 74                                       | 100/148                                                                  |
| $\text{HCO}_3^-$                          | 61         | 61                                       | 100/122                                                                  |
| $\text{OH}^-$                             | 17         | 17                                       | 100/34                                                                   |
| $\text{CO}_3^{2-}$                        | 60         | 30                                       | 100/60                                                                   |
| $\text{NaAlO}_2$                          | 82         | 82                                       | 100/164                                                                  |
| $\text{Al}_2(\text{SO}_4)_3$              | 342        | 57                                       | 100/114                                                                  |
| $\text{FeSO}_4 \cdot 7\text{H}_2\text{O}$ | 278        | 139                                      | 100/278                                                                  |
| $\text{H}^+$                              | 1          | 1                                        | 100/2                                                                    |
| $\text{HCl}$                              | 36.5       | 1                                        | 100/73                                                                   |

### Units of hardness:-

1. Parts Per Million (ppm):- is the parts of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalent hardness per  $10^6$  parts of water i.e., 1ppm= 1 part of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalent hardness in  $10^6$  parts of water.
2. Milligrams Per Litre (mg/L):- number of milligrams of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalent hardness present per liter of water.

$$1\text{mg/L}=1\text{mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ equivalent hardness of 1L of water}= 1\text{kg}=1000\text{g}=10^6\text{mg.}$$

$$\therefore 1\text{mg/L}=1\text{mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq per } 10^6 \text{ mg of water}=1\text{ppm.}$$

3. Clarke's degree ( $^\circ\text{Cl}$ ):- the no. of grains (1/7000lb) of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalent hardness per gallon (10lb) of water or it is parts of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalent hardness per 70,000 parts of water.

$$\therefore 1^\circ\text{Cl}= 1 \text{ grain of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq hardness per gallon of water}$$

$$= 1 \text{ part of CaCO}_3 \text{ hardness eq per } 10^5 \text{ parts of water.}$$

4. Degree French ( $^\circ\text{Fr}$ ):- parts of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalent hardness per  $10^5$  parts of water.

$$\therefore 1^\circ\text{Fr}= 1 \text{ part of CaCO}_3 \text{ equivalent hardness per } 10^5 \text{ parts of water.}$$

5. Milli-equivalent per liter (meq/L):- is the number of milli-equivalents of hardness present per liter.

$$1\text{meq/L}= 1\text{meq of CaCO}_3 \text{ per liter of water}$$

$$= 10^{-3} \times 50 \text{ g of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq. per liter}$$

$$= 50 \text{ mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq. per liter} = 50 \text{ mg/L of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq.} = 50\text{ppm.}$$

### Relationship between various units of hardness:

$$1 \text{ ppm} = 1 \text{ mg/L} = 0.1^\circ\text{Fr} = 0.07^\circ\text{Cl} = 0.02 \text{ meq/L}$$

$$1 \text{ mg/L} = 1 \text{ ppm} = 0.1^\circ\text{Fr} = 0.07^\circ\text{Cl} = 0.02 \text{ meq/L}$$

$$1^\circ\text{Cl} = 1.433^\circ\text{Fr} = 14.3 \text{ ppm} = 14.3 \text{ mg/L} = 0.0286\text{meq/L}$$

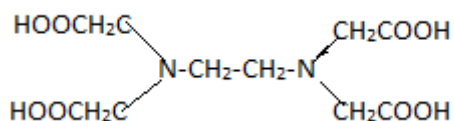
$$1^\circ\text{Fr} = 10 \text{ ppm} = 10 \text{ mg/L} = 0.7^\circ\text{Cl} = 0.2 \text{ meq/L}$$

$$1 \text{ meq/L} = 50 \text{ mg/L} = 50 \text{ ppm} = 5^\circ\text{Fr} = 0.35^\circ\text{Cl}$$

**4Q. How do you estimate the total hardness of water? Or Explain any one method for the estimation of hardness of water. Or What is the principle of EDTA method? Explain the estimation of hardness of water by complexometric method.**

*Estimation of temporary and permanent hardness:-*

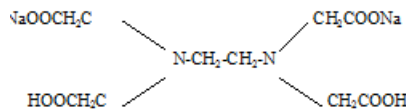
a) **EDTA(Ethylene Di amine Tetra Acetic acid) Method:-**



## Principle:

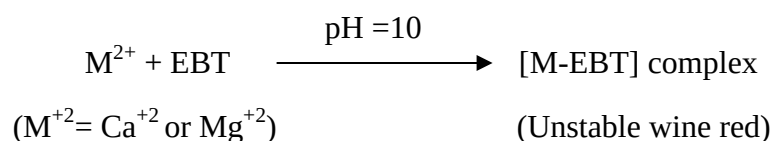
This is a complexometric method. It is in the form of its sodium salt which yields the anion and this forms complex with  $\text{Ca}^{+2}$  and  $\text{Mg}^{+2}$  ions.

(Molecular Wt. - 372.24, Equivalent Wt. - 186.14 i.e.,  $M=2N$ )

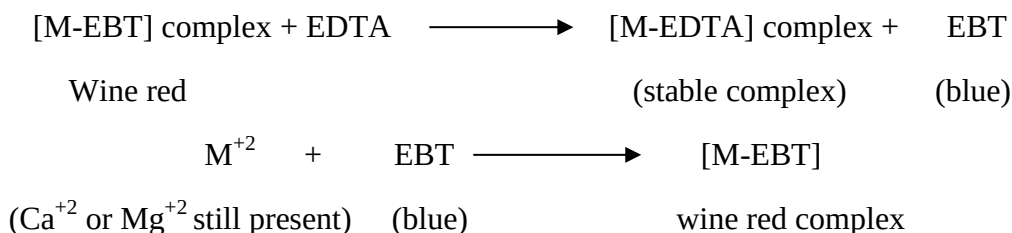


In order to determine the equivalence point (i.e., just completion of metal-EDTA complex formation) indicator **Eriochrome Black-T (EBT)** an alcoholic solution of blue dye is employed which forms an unstable *wine red* complex with  $\text{Ca}^{+2}$  and  $\text{Mg}^{+2}$  ions. The indicator is effective at about pH 10.

When EBT is added to hard water, buffered to a pH of about 10 (employing  $\text{NH}_4\text{OH-NH}_4\text{Cl}$  buffer), a wine red unstable complex is formed. Thus,

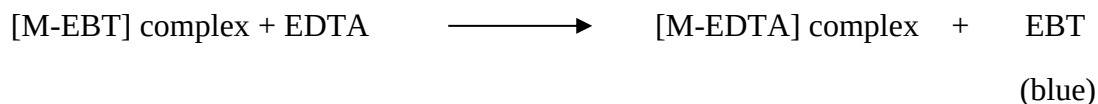


During the course of titration against EDTA solution, EDTA combines with  $\text{M}^{+2}$  (or  $\text{Ca}^{+2}$  or  $\text{Mg}^{+2}$ ) ions from stable complex M-EDTA and releasing free EBT, which instantaneously combines with  $\text{M}^{+2}$  ions still present in the solution, thereby wine red color is retained. Thus, titration



When nearly all  $\text{M}^{+2}$  ( $\text{Ca}^{+2}$  or  $\text{Mg}^{+2}$ ) ions have formed  $[\text{M-EDTA}]$  complex, then next drop of EDTA added drop wise displace the EBT indicator from  $[\text{M-EBT}]$  complex and wine red color changes to blue color (due to EBT).

Thus at equivalence point,



Thus, change of **wine red** to **blue** color marks the **end point** of titration.

## Steps involved:

1. **Preparation of Standard Hard Water:** Dissolve 1gm of pure dry  $\text{CaCO}_3$  in minimum quantity of dil. HCl and then evaporate the solution to dryness on water bath. Dissolve the residue in distilled water to make 1L solution. Each 1ml of this solution contains 1mg of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  hardness.

2. **Standardization of EDTA solution:** Rinse and fill the burette with EDTA solution. Pipette out 50ml of standard hard water in a conical flask. Add 10-15ml of buffer solution and 4 drops of indicator. Titrate with EDTA solution till wine red color changes to clear blue. Let the volume used be  $V_1$ ml.
3. **Titration of Unknown Hard Water:** Titrate 50ml of water sample just in step 5. Let the volume used be  $V_2$ ml.
4. **Titration of Permanent Hardness:** Take 250ml of water sample in a large beaker. Boil till the volume is reduced to about 50ml (all the bicarbonates are decomposed into insoluble  $\text{CaCO}_3 + \text{Mg}(\text{OH})_2$ ). Filter, wash the precipitate with distilled water collecting filtrate and washings in a 250 ml measuring flask. Finally make up the volume to 250ml with distilled water. Then titrate 50ml of boiled water sample just as in step 5. Let the volume used be  $V_3$ ml.

#### Calculations:

50 ml of standard hard water =  $V_1$  ml of EDTA.

$$\therefore 50 \times 1 \text{ mg of CaCO}_3 = V_1 \text{ ml of EDTA}$$

$$\therefore 1 \text{ ml of EDTA} = 50/V_1 \text{ mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq.}$$

50 ml of given hard water =  $V_2$  ml of EDTA.

$$= \frac{V_2 \times 50}{V_1} \text{ mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$$

$$\therefore 1 \text{ L (1000 ml) of given hard water} = \frac{V_2 \times 1000}{V_1} \text{ mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq.}$$

Total Hardness of water =  $1000 V_2/V_1$  mg/l

$$= 1000 V_2/V_1 \text{ ppm.}$$

Now 50ml of boiled water =  $V_3$  ml of EDTA.

$$= \frac{V_3 \times 1000}{V_1} \text{ mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq.}$$

$$\therefore 1 \text{ L (1000 ml) of boiled water} = 1000 V_3/V_1 \text{ mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$$

$$\therefore \text{Permanent hardness} = 1000 V_3/V_1 \text{ ppm.}$$

Temporary Hardness = total hardness - permanent hardness

$$= \frac{1000 \times V_2}{V_1} - \frac{1000 \times V_3}{V_1} = \frac{1000 \times V_2 - V_3}{V_1} \text{ ppm}$$

#### Advantages of EDTA method:

This method is preferable because of 1) greater accuracy,

2) Convenience,

3) More rapid procedure.

### Numerical Problems based on hardness of water:-

**1. Calculate the temporary and permanent hardness of water sample containing  $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 7.3\text{mg/L}$ ,  $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 16.2\text{mg/L}$ ,  $\text{MgCl}_2 = 9.5\text{mg/L}$ ,  $\text{CaSO}_4 = 13.6\text{mg/L}$ .**

Solution: conversion into  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalents:

| Constituent                                   | Multiplication factor | $\text{CaCO}_3$ equivalent              |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 7.3\text{mg/L}$  | 100/146               | $7.3 \times 100 / 146 = 5\text{mg/L}$   |
| $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 16.2\text{mg/L}$ | 100/162               | $16.2 \times 100 / 162 = 10\text{mg/L}$ |
| $\text{MgCl}_2 = 9.5\text{mg/L}$              | 100/95                | $9.5 \times 100 / 95 = 10\text{mg/L}$   |
| $\text{CaSO}_4 = 13.6\text{mg/L}$             | 100/136               | $13.6 \times 100 / 136 = 10\text{mg/L}$ |

$\therefore$  Temporary hardness of water due to  $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$  and  $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 =$   
 $= 5 + 10 = 15\text{mg/L}$  or 15ppm.

Permanent hardness due to  $\text{MgCl}_2$  and  $\text{CaSO}_4 = 10 + 10 = 20\text{mg/L}$  or 20ppm.

**2. Calculate the temporary and total hardness of a water sample containing  $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 73\text{mg/L}$ ,  $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 162\text{mg/L}$ ,  $\text{MgCl}_2 = 95\text{mg/L}$ ,  $\text{CaSO}_4 = 136\text{mg/L}$ .**

Solution: calculation of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalents:

| Constituent                                  | Multiplication factor | $\text{CaCO}_3$ equivalent              |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 73\text{mg/L}$  | 100/146               | $73 \times 100 / 146 = 50\text{mg/L}$   |
| $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 162\text{mg/L}$ | 100/162               | $162 \times 100 / 162 = 100\text{mg/L}$ |
| $\text{MgCl}_2 = 95\text{mg/L}$              | 100/95                | $95 \times 100 / 95 = 100\text{mg/L}$   |
| $\text{CaSO}_4 = 136\text{mg/L}$             | 100/136               | $136 \times 100 / 136 = 100\text{mg/L}$ |

$\therefore$  Temporary hardness of water due to  $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$  and  $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 =$   
 $= 100 + 50 = 150\text{mg/L}$  or ppm.

Total hardness of water =  $50 + 100 + 100 + 100 = 350\text{ mg/L}$  or ppm.

**3. 50ml of a sample water consumed 15ml of 0.01 EDTA before boiling and 5ml of the same EDTA after boiling. Calculate the degree of hardness, permanent hardness and temporary hardness.**

Solution: 50ml of water sample = 15ml of 0.01M EDTA

$$= \frac{15 \times 100}{50} \text{ ml of } 0.01\text{EDTA} = 300\text{ml of } 0.01\text{M EDTA}$$

= 2x300ml of 0.01 N EDTA (Molarity of EDTA=2xNormality of EDTA)

= 600 ml or 0.6 L of 0.01 eq. of  $\text{CaCO}_3$ .

=  $0.6 \times 0.01 \times 50 \text{ gCaCO}_3 \text{ eq.}$

Hence total hardness= 0.30g or 300mg of  $\text{CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$ = 300mg/L or ppm.

Now 50ml of boiled water = 5ml of 0.01M EDTA

$\therefore 1000\text{ml of boiled water} = \frac{5 \times 1000}{50} \text{ ml of 0.01M EDTA}$

= 100mL of 0.01M EDTA

= 200mL or 0.2 L of 0.01N EDTA

=  $0.2 \times 0.01 \times 50 \text{g of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$

= 0.1g or 100mg of  $\text{CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$

Hence permanent hardness = 100mg/L or ppm

$\therefore \text{Temporary hardness} = 300 - 100 = 200 \text{ ppm.}$

**4. 0.5g of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  was dissolved in HCl and the solution made up to 500ml with distilled water. 50ml of the solution required 48ml of EDTA solution for titration. 50ml of hard water sample required 15ml of EDTA and after boiling and filtering required 10ml of EDTA solution. Calculate the hardness.**

Solution: 500ml of SHW = 0.5g or 500mg  $\text{CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$

$\therefore 1\text{ml SHW} = 1\text{mg CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$

Now 48ml of EDTA solution = 50/48 mg  $\text{CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$

$\therefore 1\text{ml of EDTA solution} = 50/48 \text{ mg CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$

Calculation of the total hardness of water:

50ml hard water = 15ml EDTA =  $15 \times 50/48 \text{ mg of CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$

$\therefore 1000\text{ml of hard water} = \frac{15.625 \times 1000}{50} = 312.5 \text{ mg CaCO}_3 \text{ eq}$

Hence total hardness= 312.5mg/L or 312.5 ppm.

**5Q. Why is hard water harmful to boilers.**

**Boiler feed water:**

A boiler is a closed vessel in which water under pressure is transformed into steam by the application of heat.



Water is mainly used in boilers for the generation of steam( for industries and power houses).

A boiler feed water should correspond to the following composition:

1. Its hardness should be below 0.2 ppm.
2. Its caustic alkalinity (due to  $\text{OH}^-$ ) should lie in between 0.15ppm to 0.45ppm.
3. Its soda alkalinity (due to  $\text{Na}_2\text{CO}_3$ ) should lie in between 0.45ppm to 1ppm.

Essential requirements of boiler feed water:

1. Hardness causing and scale forming constituents like salts of calcium and magnesium. This is because scale formation would result in wastage of fuel, lowering of boiler safety, decrease in efficiency and danger of explosion.
2. Caustic alkali to avoid caustic embrittlement.
3. Dissolved gases like oxygen, carbon dioxide etc. in order to prevent boiler corrosion.
4. Turbidity, oil etc. to reduce the tendency for priming and foaming.

Hence water must be softened before use in boilers.

## **BOILER TROUBLES:**

**6Q. What are Scales and sludge's? How are they formed? What are the disadvantages and what are the methods of prevention of scale formation?**

Scale and sludge formation:

- In boilers, water evaporates continuously and the concentration of the dissolved salts increase progressively.
- When the dissolved salts concentration increases and reaches saturation point, they are thrown out of water in the form of precipitates on the inner wall of the boiler.
- If the precipitation takes place in the form of loose and slimy precipitate it is called **sludge**.
- If the precipitated matter forms a hard adhering crust or coating on the inner walls of the boiler, it is called **scale**.

**SLUDGE:** It is a soft, loose and slimy precipitate formed within the boiler.

### **Reasons:**

It is formed at comparatively colder portions of the boiler and collects where the flow of water rate is slow or at bends.

Sludge's are formed by substances which have greater solubility's in hot water than in cold water.

Eg;  $\text{MgCO}_3$ ,  $\text{MgCl}_2$ ,  $\text{CaCl}_2$ ,  $\text{MgSO}_4$ , etc.

**Disadvantages:**

Sludge's are poor conductor of heat which tends to waste a portion of heat generated.

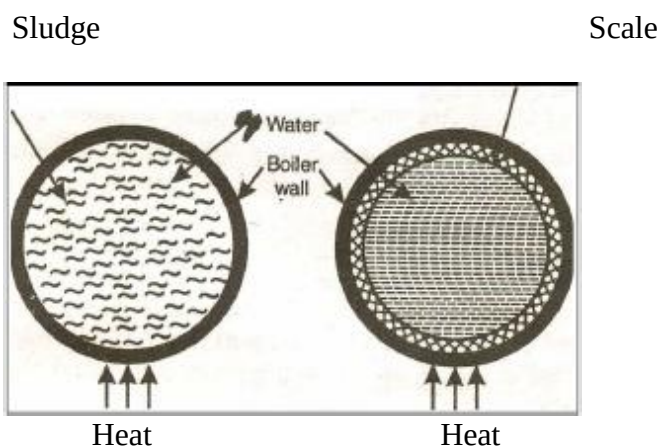
If sludge's are formed along with scales, then sludge gets entrapped in the latter and both get deposited as scales.

Sludge formation disturbs the working of the boiler as it settles in the region of poor water circulation such as pipe connection; plug opening, guage-glass connection thereby causing even choking of the pipes.

**Prevention:**

By using well softened water

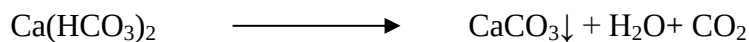
By frequent **"Blow Down"** operation i.e., drawing off a portion of the concentrated water.



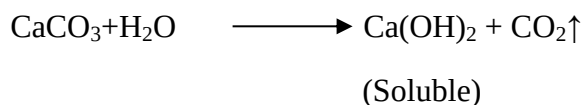
**SCALES:** are hard deposits which stick firmly to the inner surfaces of the boiler. These are difficult to remove.

**Formation of Scales:**

1. Decomposition of  $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$ :-



The formation of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  scale is soft and is the main cause of scale formation in low pressure boiler. In high pressure boilers,  $\text{CaCO}_3$  is soluble.

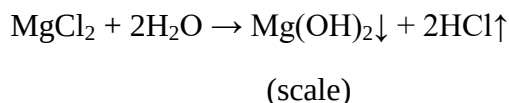


2. Deposition of  $\text{CaSO}_4$ :-

The solubility of  $\text{CaSO}_4$  in water decreases with rise in temperature i.e.,  $\text{CaSO}_4$  is soluble in cold water but completely insoluble in super-heated water.  $\text{CaSO}_4$  gets precipitated as hard scale on the heated portions of the boiler. This is the main cause of scales in high pressure boilers.

### 3. Hydrolysis of Magnesium Salts:-

The Mg salts dissolved undergo hydrolysis at high temperature forming  $\text{Mg(OH)}_2$  precipitate which forms a soft type of scale.



### 4 Presence of Silica:-

Silica present in small quantities deposits as calcium silicate ( $\text{CaSiO}_3$ ) or  $\text{MgSiO}_3$ . These deposits stick very firmly and are very difficult to remove. Important source of silica in water is the sand filter.

#### **Disadvantages:**

1. Wastage of fuel: Scales have a low thermal conductivity so rate of heat transfer from boiler to inside water is greatly decreased due to which excessive or over heating is done and this causes increase in fuel consumption.

The wastage of fuel depends upon the thickness and nature of scale as:

|                 |       |       |      |     |    |
|-----------------|-------|-------|------|-----|----|
| Thickness (mm)) | 0.325 | 0.625 | 1.25 | 2.5 | 12 |
|-----------------|-------|-------|------|-----|----|

|                 |     |     |     |     |      |
|-----------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|
| Wastage of fuel | 10% | 15% | 50% | 80% | 150% |
|-----------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|

2. Lowering of boiler safety: the overheating of boiler tube makes boiler softer and weaker and this causes distortion of boiler tube and makes the boiler unsafe to bear the pressure of steam especially in high pressure boilers.

3. Decrease in Efficiency: scales may deposit in the valves and condensers of the boilers and choke them partially. This results in decrease in efficiency of the boiler.

4. Danger of explosion: the thick scales formed if cracked due to uneven expansion the water comes suddenly in contact with overheated iron plates. This causes infiltration of a large amount of steam suddenly, so sudden high pressure is developed which causes explosion of boiler.

#### **Removal of Scales:-**

If scales are loosely adhering they can be removed with the help of scrapper or wire brush or piece of wood.

By giving thermal shocks (i.e., heating the boiler and then suddenly cooling with cold water) if they are brittle.

If the scales are hard and adhering, then dissolving them and by adding chemicals. For Eg.  $\text{CaCO}_3$  scales are dissolved by using 5-10% of HCl and  $\text{CaSO}_4$  scales can be dissolved by adding EDTA with which they form soluble complexes.

By frequent blow-down operation if scales are loosely adhering.

#### Prevention of scales:

- 1) External Treatment: includes efficient 'softening of water' (i.e. removing hardness producing constituents of water) which is discussed separately.
- 2) Internal Treatment: includes softening of water by adding a proper chemical to the boiler water. It is discussed in softening methods.

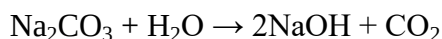
#### 7Q. Distinguish between scales and sludges.

| S.No | Sludge                                                                                                          | Scale                                                                                  |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.   | They are soft, loose and slimy precipitate.                                                                     | They form hard deposits.                                                               |
| 2.   | They form non-adherent deposits and can be easily removed.                                                      | They stick firmly to the inner surface of the boiler and are very difficult to remove. |
| 3.   | They are formed by substances like $\text{CaCl}_2$ , $\text{MgCl}_2$ , $\text{MgSO}_4$ , $\text{MgCO}_3$ , etc. | They are formed by substances like $\text{CaSO}_4$ , $\text{Mg(OH)}_2$ , etc.          |
| 4.   | They are formed at comparatively colder portions of the boiler.                                                 | They are formed at heated portions of the boiler.                                      |
| 5.   | They decrease efficiency of boiler but are less dangerous.                                                      | They decrease efficiency of boiler and chances of explosion are also there.            |
| 6.   | They can be removed by blow down operation.                                                                     | They can't be removed by blow down operation.                                          |

#### 8Q. Write briefly on caustic embrittlement.

##### **Caustic embrittlement:-**

- It is a type of boiler corrosion caused by using highly alkaline water in the boiler.
- During softening process by Lime-Soda process, free  $\text{Na}_2\text{CO}_3$  is usually present in small proportion.
- In high pressure boilers,  $\text{Na}_2\text{CO}_3$  decomposes to give NaOH and  $\text{CO}_2$  and this makes the boiler water '**caustic**'.



- The NaOH containing water flows into minute hair cracks always present in inner side of boiler by capillary action.
- Here water evaporates and the dissolved caustic soda concentration increases progressively.

- This caustic soda attacks the surrounding area, thereby dissolving iron of the boiler as sodium ferroate. This causes embrittlement of boiler parts (like bends, joints, etc.) causing even failure of the boiler.
- Caustic cracking can be explained by considering the following concentration cell:

|                                           |  |                               |  |                            |  |                              |
|-------------------------------------------|--|-------------------------------|--|----------------------------|--|------------------------------|
| -                                         |  |                               |  | +                          |  |                              |
| Iron at rivets,<br>bends, joints,<br>etc. |  | concentrated<br>NaOH solution |  | Dilute<br>NaOH<br>solution |  | Iron<br>at plane<br>surfaces |

- The iron surrounded by dil. NaOH becomes the cathodic side; while the iron in contact with con. NaOH becomes anodic part; which is consequently dissolved or corroded.

### ***Prevention of caustic embrittlement:***

Caustic embrittlement can be avoided:

- By using  $\text{Na}_3\text{PO}_4$  as softening reagent instead of  $\text{Na}_2\text{CO}_3$ .
- By adding tannin or lignin to boiler water since these block the hair cracks there by preventing infiltration of caustic soda solution in these.
- By adding  $\text{Na}_2\text{SO}_4$  to boiler water.  $\text{Na}_2\text{SO}_4$  is added to boiler water so that the ratio  $\frac{\text{Na}_2\text{SO}_4 \text{ Concentration}}{\text{NaOH Concentration}}$  is kept as 1:1:2:1 and 3:1 in boilers working respectively at pressures up to 10, 20 and 30 atmospheres.

### ***Disadvantages of caustic embrittlement:***

The cracking or weakening of the boiler metal causes failure of the boiler.

### **9Q. Write a short notes on carry over or priming and foaming.**

#### **Carry over or priming and foaming:**

##### ***Priming:***

When a boiler is steaming (i.e., producing steam) rapidly, some particles of the liquid water are carried along with the steam. This process of '*wet steam*' formation is known as '**Priming**'.

##### ***Causes:***

Priming is caused by:

1. The presence of large amount of dissolved salts
2. High steam velocities
3. Sudden boiling

4. Improper boiler design
5. Sudden increase in steam production rate.

***Prevention:***

1. By fitting mechanical purifiers
2. Avoiding rapid change in steam rate
3. Maintaining low water levels in boilers
4. Effective softening and filtration of boiler feed water
5. Blow down of the boiler.

***Foaming:***

The phenomenon of formation of *persistent foam or bubbles* on the surface of water inside the boiler, which do not break easily.

***Causes:***

1. Pure water has very little foaming whereas the water containing dissolved impurities and suspended matter has a greater tendency to produce foam.
2. The presence of large quantity of suspended impurities and oils lowers the surface tension producing foam.

***Prevention:***

1. Adding antifoaming chemicals like castor oil.
2. Besides castor oil, Gallic acid and tannic acids, corn oil, cotton seed oil, sperm oil, bees wax, etc., are also used as antifoaming agents.
3. Blow down operation of the boiler can prevent foaming.
4. Removing oil from boiler water by adding compounds like sodium aluminate.

***Disadvantages of Priming and Foaming:***

Priming and Foaming usually occur together. They are objectionable because:-

1. The dissolved salts in boiler water are carried by the wet steam to super heater and turbine blades where they get deposited and reduce the efficiency.
2. The dissolved salts enter the parts of other machinery where steam is used thereby decreasing the life of machinery.
3. The actual height of the water column cannot be judged thereby making the maintenance of boiler pressure becomes difficult.

10Q. Give a detailed account on boiler corrosion Or Write a note on mechanical deaeration.

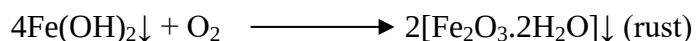
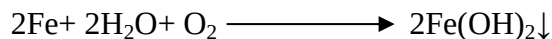
**Boiler corrosion:**

- The decay of boiler material by chemical or electrochemical attack by its environment is known as “**Boiler corrosion**”.
- The main reasons for boiler corrosion are:-

**Dissolved Oxygen:** water contains usually about 8ml of dissolved oxygen per liter at room temperature.

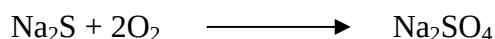
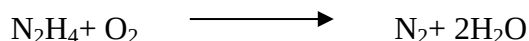
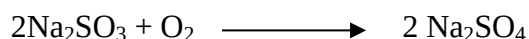
Disadvantages of dissolved oxygen:

In presence of prevailing high temperature, the dissolved Oxygen attacks boiler material as follows:



**Removal of dissolved Oxygen:**

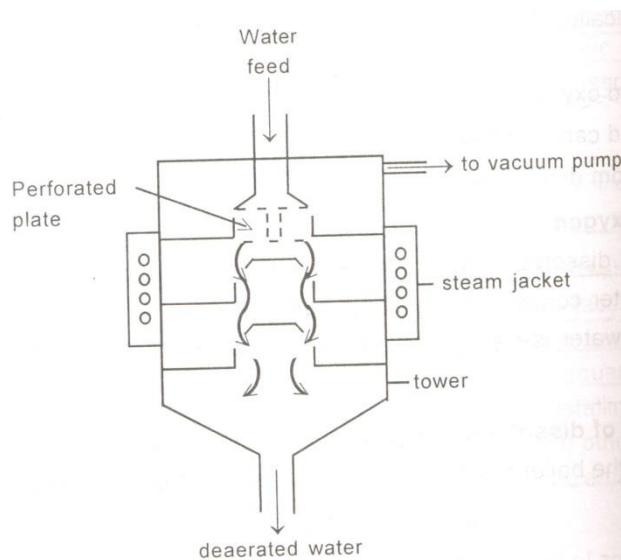
- 1) By adding calculated quantity of Sodium sulphite ( $\text{Na}_2\text{SO}_3$ ) or hydrazine( $\text{N}_2\text{H}_4$ ) or sodium sulphide ( $\text{Na}_2\text{S}$ ).



Hydrazine is an ideal internal treatment chemical for the removal of dissolved oxygen.

Azamina 8001-RD (a polyvalent organic compound) has been employed for degassing water in minimum time.

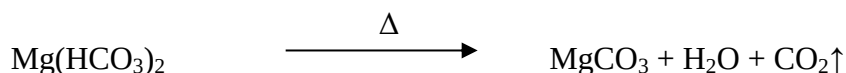
- 2) By Mechanical de-aeration i.e., spraying water through a perforated plate fitted in degasification tower, heated from sides and connected to a vacuum pump as shown in the figure.



High temperature, low pressure and large exposed surface (provided by perforated plates) reduce the dissolved oxygen in water.

3) Dissolved Carbon dioxide: has a slow corrosive effect on the materials of boiler plate.

Under the high temperature and pressure the bicarbonates decompose to produce CO<sub>2</sub>.



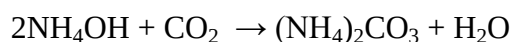
***Disadvantages of CO<sub>2</sub>:***

It has slow corrosive effect on boiler plates by producing the carbonic acid.



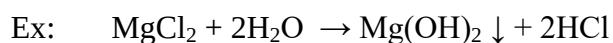
***Removal of CO<sub>2</sub>:***

By adding calculated amount of ammonia.



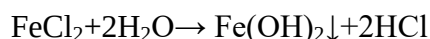
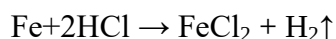
By mechanical deaeration process along with oxygen.

***Acids from dissolved salts:*** water containing dissolved Mg salts liberate acids on hydrolysis.



***Disadvantages of acids:***

The acids react with the iron of boiler plate in a chain reaction producing HCl again and again.



Presence of even a small amount of MgCl<sub>2</sub> will have corrosion of iron to a large extent.

***Prevention of acid corrosion:***

1) By softening of boiler water to remove MgCl<sub>2</sub> from the water.

2) By frequent blow down operation.

3) Addition of inhibitors to form a thin film on the surface of the boiler protecting the metal from attack. Sodium silicates, sodium phosphates and sodium chromate acts as good corrosion inhibitors.

**11Q. Write short notes on phosphate conditioning Or Write short notes on the following: (a) Calgon conditioning (b) Carbonate conditioning (c) phosphate conditioning Or Compare Phosphate conditioning with calgon conditioning.**



## **Softening methods:-**

- 1) **Internal treatment**
- 2) **External treatment**

Water used for industrial purposes should be sufficiently pure. It should therefore be freed from hardness producing salts before use.

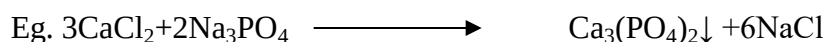
The process of removing hardness producing salts from water is known as '**Softening**' of water.

### **1) Internal treatment: (sequestration)**

- In this process, an ion is prohibited to exhibit its original character by *complexing* or converting into other more soluble salt by adding appropriate agent.
- An internal treatment is accomplished by adding a proper chemical to the boiler water either:
  - i) To precipitate the scale forming impurities in the form of sludges which can be removed by blow-down operation or
  - ii) To convert them into compounds which will stay in the dissolved form in water, and thus do not cause harm.
- The important internal conditioning /treatment methods are:

#### **1) Phosphate Conditioning:**

In high pressure boilers, scale formation can be avoided by adding sodium phosphate, which reacts with hardness of water, forming non-adherent and easily removable, soft sludge of Ca and Mg phosphates which can be removed by blow-down operation.



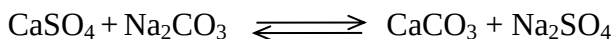
The main phosphates employed are

1.  $\text{NaH}_2\text{PO}_4$ : sodium dihydrogen phosphate(acidic)
2.  $\text{Na}_2\text{HPO}_4$ : disodium hydrogen phosphate(weakly alkaline)
3.  $\text{Na}_3\text{PO}_4$ : trisodium phosphate(alkaline)

The choice of salt depends upon the alkalinity of boiler feed water.

#### **2) Carbonate Conditioning:**

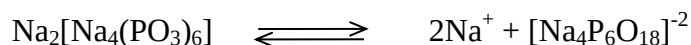
In low pressure boilers, scale formation can be avoided by adding Sodium carbonate to boiler water, when  $\text{CaSO}_4$  is converted to  $\text{CaCO}_3$  in equilibrium.



#### **3) Calgon Conditioning:**

Involves adding calgon (sodium hexa meta phosphate ( $\text{NaPO}_3$ )<sub>6</sub>) to boiler water.

It prevents the scale and sludge formation by forming soluble complex compound with  $\text{CaSO}_4$ .



(Sodium hexa meta phosphate)



(Soluble complex ion)

**12Q. Explain the basic principles involved along with the chemical reactions for following and their advantages Lime soda process Or Explain the basic principle, different methods, advantages and disadvantages of lime-soda process Or Describe the cold and hot lime soda process for softening of hard water.**

## **2) external treatment:**

Involves Lime-Soda, Zeolite, Ion-exchange process.

### **a) *Lime-Soda process:***

In this process, **lime**  $[(\text{Ca}(\text{OH})_2)]$  and **soda**  $[\text{Na}_2\text{CO}_3]$  are the reagents used to precipitate the dissolved salts of  $\text{Ca}^{+2}$  and  $\text{Mg}^{+2}$  as  $\text{CaCO}_3$  and  $\text{Mg}(\text{OH})_2$  which are later on filtered off.

Lime reacts with temporary hardness causing salts, Mg permanent hardness,  $\text{CO}_2$ , acids, bicarbonates and alums.

Lime cannot remove permanent hardness which should be removed by soda.

*Precautions to be followed during process:*

Only calculated amounts of lime and soda must be added. Excess of lime-soda causes boiler troubles like corrosion and caustic embrittlement.

The chemical reactions of lime and soda are slow and the precipitates  $\text{CaCO}_3$  and  $\text{Mg}(\text{OH})_2$  are very fine.

Proper time must be given for the reactions of softening process to complete, because all the reactions of the process are slow.

### ***Cold lime soda process:***

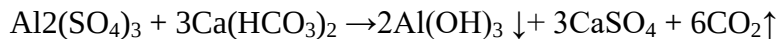
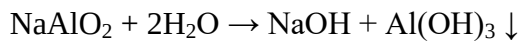
Calculated amounts of lime and soda are mixed with water at room temperature.

The precipitates formed are finely divided which do not settle down and can't be filtered easily.

So, it is essential to add small amounts of coagulants (like alum, aluminium sulphate, sodium aluminate) which hydrolyse to flocculent, gelatinous precipitate of  $\text{Al}(\text{OH})_3$  and entraps the precipitate.

Use of sodium aluminate as **Coagulant** also helps in the removal of silica as well as oil present in the water.

Cold lime soda process provides water containing residual hardness of 50-60 ppm.



### **Method:**

Raw water and calculated quantities of chemicals (lime+soda+coagulant) are fed from the top into inner vertical circular chamber fitted with a vertical rotating shaft carrying a number of paddles.

As the raw water and chemicals flow down, there is vigorous stirring and continuous mixing whereby softening of water takes place.

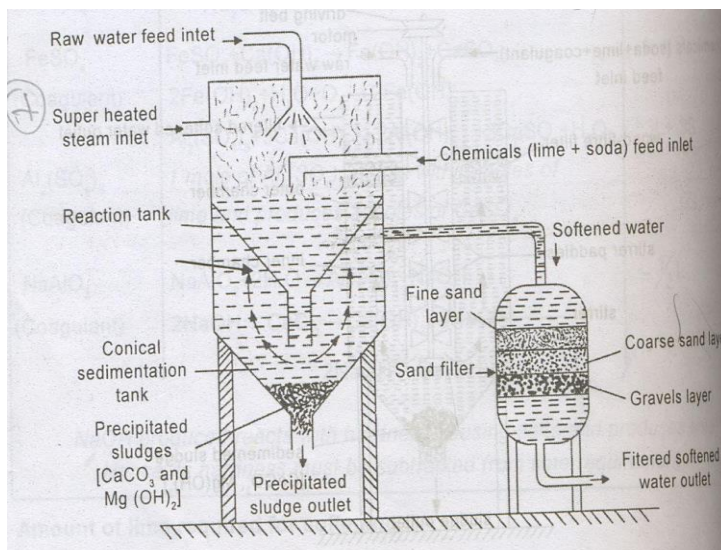
The heavy sludge settles down in the outer chamber by the time softened water reaches up.

The softened water then passes through a filtering media (made of wood fibres) to ensure complete removal of sludge.

Filtered soft water finally flows out continuously through the outlet at the top and sludge settling at the bottom of the outer chamber is drawn off occasionally.

### **Hot Lime Soda Process:**

It involves treating water with softening chemicals at a temperature of  $80^0$ - $150^0$  C. Since hot process is operated at a temperature close to the boiling point of the solution, so



- a) The reaction proceeds faster,
- b) Softening capacity of hot process is increased,
- c) The precipitate and sludge formed settle down rapidly and hence no coagulants are needed,
- d) Much of the dissolved gases ( $\text{CO}_2$ ) are driven out,
- e) Viscosity of softened water is lower so filtration of water becomes much easier.

Hot lime soda process produces water of residual hardness of 15-30ppm.

### **Process:**

It contains essentially three parts

- 1) A reaction tank in which water, chemical and steam are thoroughly mixed.
- 2) A conical sedimentation vessel in which sludge settle down.
- 3) A sand filter which ensures complete removal of sludge from the softened water.

**Advantages of Lime-Soda process:**

- 1) It is very economical.
- 2) The process increases the pH value of treated water thereby corrosion of distribution pipes is reduced.
- 3) Besides removal of hardness causing salts, minerals, iron and manganese present in water is removed.
- 4) Due to alkaline nature, amount of pathogenic bacteria in water is considerably reduced.

**Disadvantages Of Lime-Soda Process:**

- 1) Skilled supervision is required for efficient and economical softening.
- 2) Disposal of large amounts of sludge poses a problem.
- 3) This can remove hardness only up to 15ppm, which is not good for boilers.

**13Q. Write the differences between cold and hot lime soda process.**

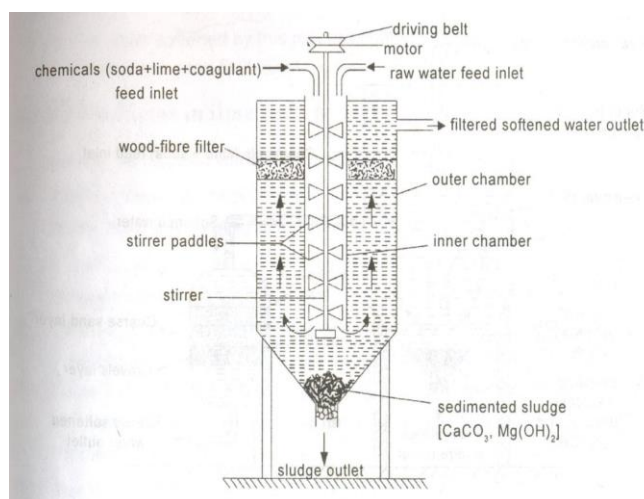
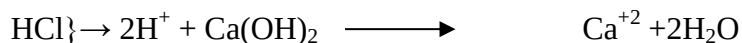
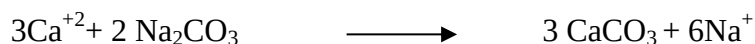
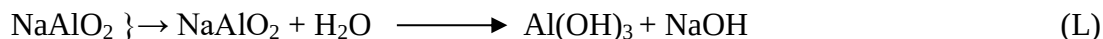
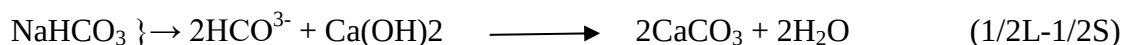
Differences between cold and hot lime soda process:-

| S.No | Cold Lime Soda Process                              | Hot Lime Soda Process                                                          |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.   | It is done at room temperature.                     | It is done at elevated temperatures (84-100 °C).                               |
| 2.   | It is slow process.                                 | It is rapid process.                                                           |
| 3.   | Use of coagulants is must.                          | Coagulants are not needed.                                                     |
| 4.   | Filtration is not easy.                             | Filtration is easy as viscosity of water becomes low at elevated temperatures. |
| 5.   | Softened water has residual hardness around 60 ppm. | Softened water has residual hardness around 15-30 ppm.                         |
| 6.   | Dissolved gases are not removed.                    | Dissolved gases such as CO <sub>2</sub> are removed to some extent.            |
| 7.   | It has low softening capacity.                      | It has high softening capacity.                                                |

**Points to be followed while solving problems in lime soda problems:**

- 1) To convert the hardness of the hardness causing salts in terms of CaCO<sub>3</sub> equivalents.
- 2) If CaCO<sub>3</sub> is given as hardness causing salt, it should also be considered as temporary hardness expressed in terms of CaCO<sub>3</sub>.
- 3) MgCO<sub>3</sub>, Mg(HCO<sub>3</sub>)<sub>2</sub>, should be converted to CaCO<sub>3</sub> equivalents.
- 4) Some salts like NaCl, KCl, Silica, K<sub>2</sub>SO<sub>4</sub>, Fe<sub>2</sub>O<sub>3</sub> neither cause hardness nor react with lime and soda. Hence they must not be considered for calculation of lime and soda required.
- 5) The hardness of Al<sub>2</sub>(SO<sub>4</sub>)<sub>3</sub> must be multiplied by 3 for both lime and soda, HCl hardness must be multiplied by 0.5, Mg(HCO<sub>3</sub>)<sub>2</sub> hardness must be multiplied by 2, NaHCO<sub>3</sub>, KHCO<sub>3</sub>, NaAlO<sub>2</sub> hardness

must be multiplied by 0.5 and should be subtracted for calculation of amount of lime and soda required respectively.



6) Soda ( $\text{Na}_2\text{CO}_3$ ) reacts only with permanent hardness causing  $\text{Ca}^{+2}$  salts.

Now 100 parts by mass of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  are equivalent to:

74 parts of  $\text{Ca}(\text{OH})_2$  and 106 parts of  $\text{Na}_2\text{CO}_3$ .

∴ Lime requirement for softening =

$74/100[\text{Temp. Ca}^{+2} + 2 \times \text{temp Mg}^{+2} + \text{perm}(\text{Mg}^{+2}) + \text{CO}_2 + 1/2\text{HCl} + \text{H}_2\text{SO}_4 + 1/2\text{NaHCO}_3 + 1/2\text{KHCO}_3 + \text{FeSO}_4 - \text{NaAlO}_2 + 3\text{Al}_2(\text{SO}_4)_3]$

all in terms of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalents.

∴ Soda requirement for softening =

$106/100 [\text{permanent} (\text{Ca}^{+2} + \text{Mg}^{+2} + \text{Fe}^{+2}) + 1/2\text{HCl} + \text{H}_2\text{SO}_4 - 1/2\text{NaHCO}_3 - 1/2\text{KHCO}_3 + 3\text{Al}_2(\text{SO}_4)_3]$

all in terms of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalents.

### Numerical Problems based on Lime-Soda Process:

**1. Calculate the amount of lime and soda required for the treatment of 10,000l of water containing the following salts dissolved per litre.  $\text{CaCO}_3=50$  mg,  $\text{CaCl}_2=11.1$  mg,  $\text{MgSO}_4=12$  mg,  $\text{NaHCO}_3=7.25$  mg, silica=10 mg.**

Solution: conversion of the hardness in terms of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalents:

Constituent Multiplication factor  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalent

$\text{CaCO}_3=50$  mg  $100/100$   $50 \times 100/100=50$  mg/L

$$\text{CaCl}_2 = 11.1 \text{ mg } 100/111 \quad 11.1 \times 100/111 = 10 \text{ mg/L}$$

$$\text{MgSO}_4 = 12 \text{ mg } 100/120 \quad 12 \times 100/120 = 10 \text{ mg/L}$$

$$\text{NaHCO}_3 = 7.25 \text{ mg } 100/84 \quad 7.25 \times 100/84 = 8.63 \text{ mg/L}$$

$$\text{Amount of lime required} = 74 [\text{CaCO}_3 + 1/2 \text{NaHCO}_3 + \text{MgSO}_4]$$

$$100$$

$$= 74 [50 + 4.3 + 10]$$

$$100$$

$$= 47.58 \text{ mg/L}$$

$$\text{Amount of lime required for 10,000L of water} = 47.58 \times 10,000$$

$$= 4,75,800 \text{ mg/10,000L}$$

$$= 0.4758 \text{ Kg/10,000L.}$$

$$\text{Amount of Soda required} = 106 [\text{CaCl}_2 + \text{MgSO}_4 - 1/2 \text{NaHCO}_3]/100$$

$$= 106 [10 + 10 - 4.3] / 100$$

$$= 16.64 \text{ mg/L}$$

$$\text{Soda required for 10,000L of water} = 16.64 \times 10,000$$

$$= 166,400 \text{ mg/10,000L}$$

$$= 0.1664 \text{ Kg/10,000L.}$$

**2. Explain with chemical equations and calculate the amount of lime and soda required for softening of 1,00,000l of water containing the following:**

$$\text{HCl} = 7.3 \text{ mg/L, Al}_2(\text{SO}_4)_3 = 34.2 \text{ mg/L, MgCl}_2 = 9.5 \text{ mg/L, NaCl} = 29.25 \text{ mg/L.}$$

Purity of lime is 90% and that of soda is 98%. 10% of chemicals are to be used in excess in order to complete the reaction quickly.

Solution: conversion into  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalents:

Constituent Multiplication factor  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalent

$$\text{HCl} = 7.3 \text{ mg/L } 100/73 \quad 7.3 \times 100/73 = 10 \text{ mg/L}$$

$$\text{Al}_2(\text{SO}_4)_3 = 34.2 \text{ mg/L } 100/114 \quad 34.2 \times 100/114 = 30 \text{ mg/L}$$

$$\text{MgCl}_2 = 9.5 \text{ mg/L } 100/95 \quad 9.5 \times 100/95 = 10 \text{ mg/L}$$

$$\text{Lime requirement} = 74/100 [\text{HCl} + 3\text{Al}_2(\text{SO}_4)_3 + \text{MgCl}_2] \times \text{volume of water} \times 100/\% \text{purity}$$

$$= 74/100 (10 + 90 + 10) \times 1,00,000 \times 100/90$$

$$= 9.04 \text{ Kg}$$

∴ Lime required (using 10% excess) =  $9.04 \times 110 / 100 = 9.944$  Kg

Soda requirement =  $106 / 100 [\text{HCl} + \text{Al}_2(\text{SO}_4)_3 + \text{MgCl}_2] \times \text{volume of water} \times 100 / \% \text{purity}$

=  $106 / 100 (10 + 90 + 10) \times 1,00,000 \times 100 / 98$

= 11.8 Kg

∴ Soda required (using 10% excess) =  $11.8 \times 110 / 100 = 12.98$  Kg.

**14Q. Write short notes on Ion-exchange process. Or What are ion-exchange resins? How will you purify water by using them? Or What are the advantages of this method over other methods?**

**Ion exchange/deionization/demineralization:-**

Ion exchange resins are insoluble, cross linked, long chain organic polymers with a micro porous structure and the functional groups attached to the chains are responsible for ion exchanging properties.

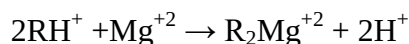
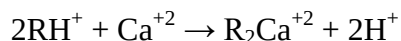
Resins containing acidic functional groups ( $-\text{COOH}$ ,  $-\text{SO}_3\text{H}$ ) are capable of exchanging their cations; those containing basic functional groups ( $-\text{NH}_2$ ,  $-\text{NH}-$ ) as  $\text{HCl}$  are capable of exchanging their anions with other anions, which comes in their contact.

The ion exchange resins may be classified as :-

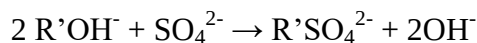
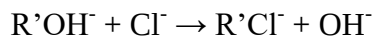
- 1) **Cation Exchange Resins ( $\text{RH}^+$ ):-** are mainly styrene-divinyl benzene co-polymers which on sulphonation or carboxylation become capable to exchange their  $\text{H}^+$  ions with cations in the water.
- 2) **Anion Exchange Resins ( $\text{R}'\text{OH}^-$ ):-** are styrene-divinyl benzene and amine formaldehyde copolymers which contain amino or quaternary ammonium or quaternary phosphonium or tertiary sulphonium groups as an integral part of resin matrix. These, after treatment with dil  $\text{NaOH}$  solution, become capable to exchange their  $\text{OH}^-$  anions with anions in water.

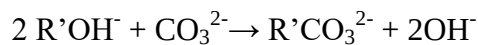
**Process:-**

Raw water is first passed through cation exchanger and the removal of cations take place like  $\text{Ca}^{+2}$ ,  $\text{Mg}^{+2}$  etc takes place and equivalent amount of  $\text{H}^+$  ions are released from this column to water. Thus,



After cation exchange column the hard water is passed through anion exchange column, which removes all the anions like  $\text{SO}_4^{2-}$ ,  $\text{Cl}^-$  etc present in the water and equivalent amount of  $\text{OH}^-$  ions are released from this column to water.





$\text{H}^+$  and  $\text{OH}^-$  ions (released from cation exchange and anion exchange columns respectively) get combined to produce water molecule.



Thus, water coming out from the exchanger is free from cations as well as anions. Ion-free water is known as **deionized or demineralized water**.

### Regeneration:

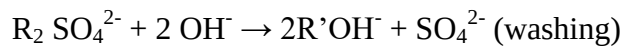
After the deionization of certain amount of raw water the cation and anion exchangers will be exhausted.

Regeneration of cation exchanger is carried out by passing dil. HCl or  $\text{H}_2\text{SO}_4$  solution into the bed.



The column is washed with deionized water and the washings ( $\text{Ca}^{+2}$ ,  $\text{Mg}^{+2}$  etc and  $\text{Cl}^-$  or  $\text{SO}_4^{2-}$ ) is passed to sink or drain.

The exhausted anion exchange column is regenerated by passing a solution of dil. NaOH.



The column is washed with deionized water and washings containing  $\text{Na}^+$  and  $\text{SO}_4^{2-}$  or  $\text{Cl}^-$  ions is passed to sink or drain.

The regenerated ion exchange resins are then used again.

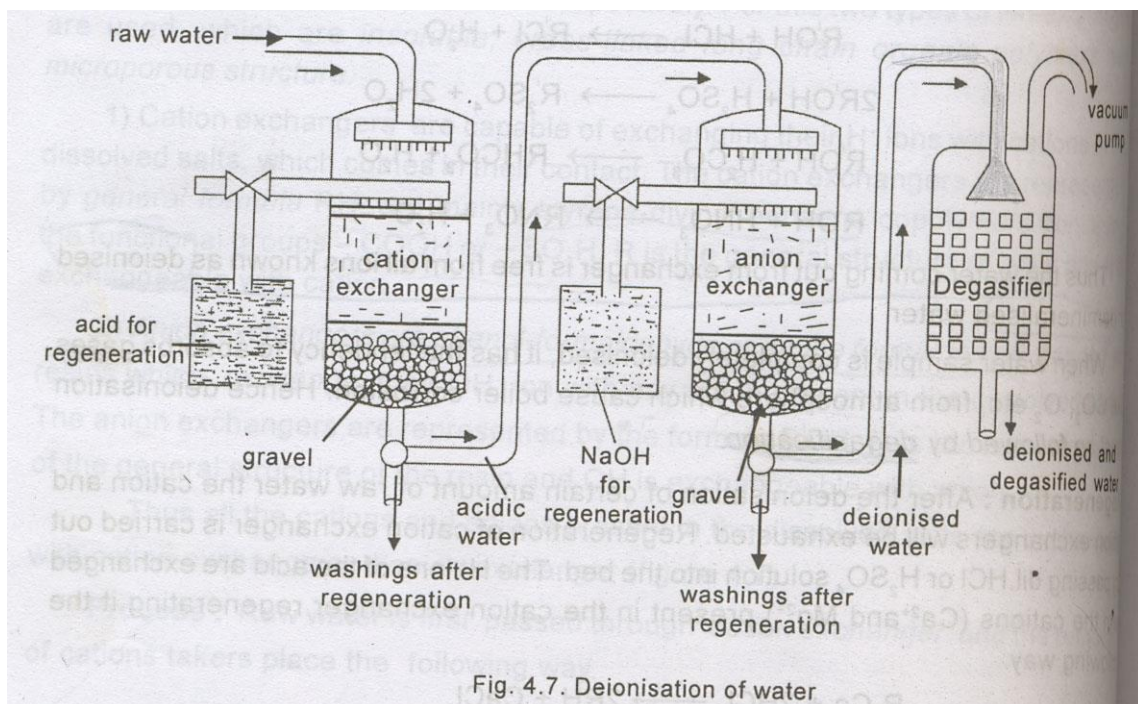


Fig. 4.7. Deionisation of water



**Advantages:**

- 1) Highly acidic or alkaline water samples can be purified by this process.
- 2) The hardness possessed by the deionised water is 2ppm.
- 3) The deionised water is most suitable for high pressure boilers.

**Disadvantages:**

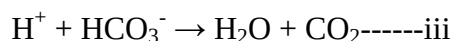
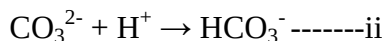
- 1) The ion exchanging resins are expensive hence the cost of purification is high.
- 2) Raw water should contain turbidity below 10ppm. Otherwise pores in the resin will be blocked and output of the process is reduced.

**15Q. Write short notes on alkalinity of water.*****Alkalinity and its determination:***

Alkalinity refers to the presence of bases ( $\text{OH}^-$ ,  $\text{CO}_3^{2-}$ ,  $\text{HCO}_3^-$ ) in a solution that can be converted to uncharged species by a strong acid.

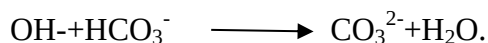
Alkalinity can be measured by titrating a sample with a standard acid using phenolphthalein and methyl orange indicators.

The following reactions take place during the addition of acid to the water sample solution:



The titration of the water sample with a standard acid up to the phenolphthalein end point marks the completion of reactions i and ii only. The amount of acid consumed corresponds to hydroxide plus one half of the carbonate present. The titration of the water sample with a standard acid to methyl orange end point marks the completion of all the reactions above. Hence, the amount of the total acid consumed corresponds to the total alkalinity and the amount of acid used after the phenolphthalein end point corresponds to the one half of carbonate plus all the bicarbonates.

The alkalinity in water can be due to  $\text{OH}^-$  only or carbonate only or bicarbonate only or due to their combinations. But  $\text{OH}^-$  and bicarbonate can't exist together because they combine instantaneously to form carbonate ions.



On the basis of same reasoning all the three  $\text{OH}^-$  carbonate and bicarbonate cannot exist together.

Determination of alkalinity:

Pipette out 100 mL of the water sample into a clean conical flask.

Add 2-3 drops of phenolphthalein indicator to the sample and stir.

Titrate with sulphuric acid solution from the burette to the contents of the flask until the pink colour disappears.

Note down the titre value.

Then add 2-3 drops of methyl orange indicator to same solution and titrate further with standard acid solution till pink colour reappears.

Again note down the titre value.

**Calculations:**

Volume of water sample taken= 100 ml

Concentration of sulphuric acid solution= X N.

Volume of acid consumed for phenolphthalein end point =  $V_1$  ml.

Volume of acid consumed for methyl orange end point =  $V_2$  ml.

Concentration of phenolphthalein alkalinity =  $V_1 X / 100$ .

Phenolphthalein alkalinity in terms of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalents =  $P = V_1 X 50 / 100 \text{ gm/L}$ .

$$= P = V_1 X 50 \cdot 10^6 / 100 \times 1000 \text{ ppm.}$$

Methyl orange alkalinity in terms of  $\text{CaCO}_3$  equivalents=

$$M = (V_1 + V_2) X 50 \cdot 10^6 / 100 \times 1000 \text{ ppm.}$$

Then the calculation of  $\text{OH}^-$ ,  $\text{CO}_3^{2-}$ ,  $\text{HCO}_3^-$  can be calculated as follows:

1. When  $P=0$ , both  $\text{OH}^-$ ,  $\text{CO}_3^{2-}$  are absent and alkalinity is due to bicarbonate only.
2. When  $P=1/2M$ , only  $\text{CO}_3^{2-}$  is present since half of carbonate neutralization reaction takes place with phenolphthalein indicator while complete neutralization takes place when methyl orange indicator is used. Therefore, alkalinity due to  $\text{CO}_3^{2-} = 2P$ .
3. When  $P=M$  only  $\text{OH}^-$  is present. Thus alkalinity due to  $\text{OH}^- = P=M$ .
4. When  $P>1/2M$  both  $\text{OH}^-$ ,  $\text{CO}_3^{2-}$  are present. Now half of  $\text{CO}_3^{2-} = M - P$ . therefore, alkalinity due to  $\text{CO}_3^{2-} = 2(M-P)$  and alkalinity due to  $\text{OH}^- = M - 2(M-P) = 2P - M$ .
5. When  $P<1/2M$ , carbonates and bicarbonates are present. Now alkalinity due to carbonates =  $2P$ . Therefore alkalinity due to bicarbonate=  $M - 2P$ .

**16Q. Write short notes on ozonation of water.**

**Sterilization by ozonation:** Water sterilization is recommended whenever drinking water is to be consumed, when retrieving water from a contaminated well or other sources, or any time surface water is treated prior to consumption. Ozone is the most excellent and effective water sterilizing method available today.

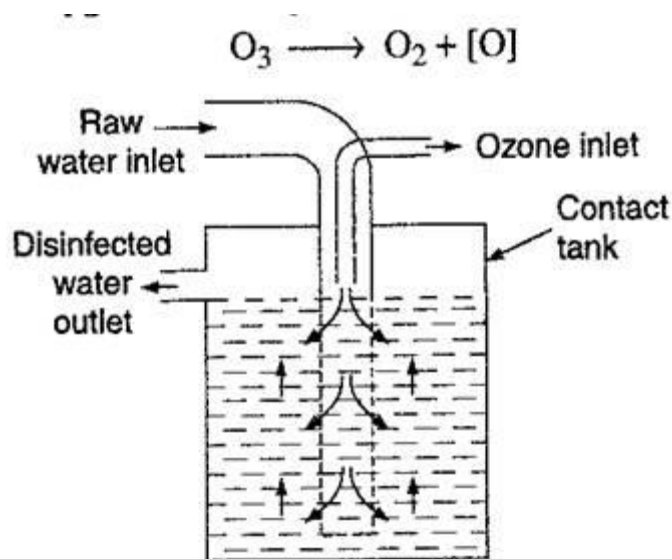
Ozone is a very reactive and unstable gas with a short half-life before it reverts back to oxygen. Ozone is the most powerful and rapid acting oxidizer man can produce, and will oxidize all bacteria, mold and yeast spores, organic material and viruses given sufficient exposure. It is said to be:

- 50 times more powerful than chlorine and
- 3000 times faster at killing bacteria and other microbes
- Does not leave any by-products such as, with chlorine which creates trihalomethanes (THM's).

Ozone is an unstable allotropic form of oxygen. When added to water, ozone breaks up into oxygen and nascent oxygen.

Ozone is made up of three oxygen atoms ( $O_3$ ) a "free radical" of oxygen. It will readily give up one atom of oxygen providing a powerful oxidising agent which is toxic to most waterborne organisms such as bacteria, mold and yeast spores, viruses or harmful protozoa that form cysts.

This single Oxygen atom binds with these substances causing them to oxidize (think iron turning into Iron Oxide - Rust). The by-product of this oxidation is a single Oxygen atom.



***The advantages of using Ozone Water Purification include:***

- Ozone is primarily a disinfectant that effectively kills biological contaminants.
- Ozone also oxidizes and precipitates iron, sulphur, and manganese so they can be filtered out.
- Ozone will oxidize and break down many organic chemicals including many that cause odour and taste problems.
- Ozonation removes taste colour and odour in the water.

- Ozone is made of oxygen and reverts to pure oxygen and it vanishes without a trace once it has been used.

***The disadvantages of using Ozone Water Purification include:***

- Ozone treatment can create undesirable by products, formaldehyde and bromate, that can be harmful to health if they are not controlled.
- The process of creating ozone in the home requires electricity. Loss of power means no purification.
- Ozone is ineffective at removing dissolved minerals and salts.
- Water companies that use ozone to disinfect the water must add chlorine or another disinfectant must be added to minimize microbial growth during storage and distribution.

**17Q. Write the characteristics of potable water and what are the steps involved in treatment of municipal water?**

***Standards required for Potable water:***

Potable water is generally obtained from rivers and lakes. Water obtained from these sources are never pure and as such it is unfit for drinking.

Characteristics:

1. It should be safe.
2. It should be clear and odour less.
3. It should be pleasant in taste.
4. It should be perfectly cool.
5. Its turbidity should not exceed 10 ppm.
6. It should be free from objectional dissolved gases like  $H_2S$ .
7. It should be free from minerals such as lead, arsenic, chromium, manganese salts.
8. Its alkalinity should not be high.
9. It should be reasonably soft.
10. Its total dissolved solids should be less than 500ppm.
11. It should be free from disease producing microorganisms.

**Municipal Water Treatment:**

The type of treatment is given to water largely depends upon the quality of raw water and also upon specified standards.

In general water treatment for municipal supply or domestic use consists of following stages:

### **1. Removal of suspended impurities:**

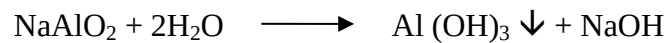
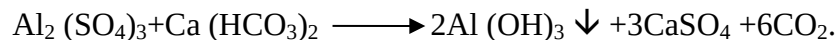
a) Screening: the raw water is passed through screens having large no. of holes where floating materials are retained.

b) Sedimentation: is a process of allowing water to stand undisturbed in big tanks about 5m deep when most of suspended particles settle down at the bottom due to force of gravity.

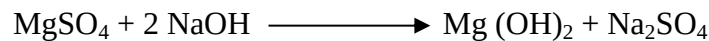
c) Coagulation: sedimentation with coagulation is the process of removing fine suspended and colloidal impurities by addition of coagulants (chemicals) to water before sedimentation.

Coagulant when added to water form insoluble gelatinous, flocculant precipitate which descent through the water, adsorbs and entangles very fine suspended impurities forming bigger flocs, which settle down easily.

Eg. Alum [ $K_2SO_4 \cdot Al_2(SO_4)_3 \cdot 24H_2O$ ],  $NaAlO_2$ ,  $FeSO_4 \cdot 7H_2O$ .



The aluminium hydroxide floc causes sedimentation. The sodium hydroxide thus produced, precipitates magnesium salts such as  $Mg(OH)_2$ .



d) Filtration: the process of removing colloidal matter and most of the bacteria, microorganism by passing water through a bed of fine sand and other proper sized granular materials.

A sand filter consists of a thick top layer of fine sand placed over coarse sand layer and gravels. It is provided with an inlet for water and an under drain channel at the bottom for exit of filtered water. Sedimented water entering the sand filter is uniformly distributed over the entire fine sand bed. During filtration, the sand pores get clogged, due to retention of impurities in the pores.

When the rate of filtration become slow the working of filter is stopped and about 2-3cm of the top fine sand layer is scrapped off and replaced with clean sand and the filter is put back into use again. The scrapped sand is washed with water, dried and stored for reuse at the time of next scrapping operation.

### **2. Removal of microorganisms:**

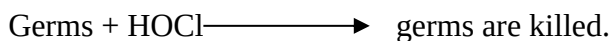
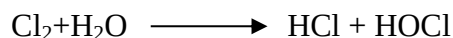
Water used particularly for drinking purpose must be freed from diseases producing bacteria, microorganism etc from the water and making it safe for use, is called disinfection.

The chemicals or substances which are added to water for killing the bacteria are known as disinfectants.

a) Boiling: water boiled for 10-15 minutes kills all the disease producing bacteria.

b) Adding bleaching powder: 1 kg of bleaching powder per 1000 kilo litres of water is mixed and water is allowed to stand undisturbed for several hours.

The chemical action produces hypochlorous acid, a powerful germicide.



The disinfecting action of bleaching powder is due to the chlorine made available by it.

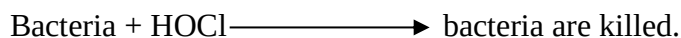
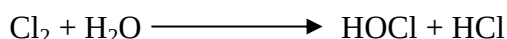
**Drawbacks:**

Bleaching powder introduces calcium in water which makes it harder.

Bleaching powder deteriorates due to its continuous decomposition during storage.

Excess of bleaching powder gives bad taste and smell to treated water.

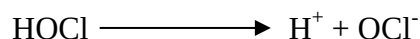
c) By chlorination: chlorine (either in gas or in concentrated solution form) produces hypochlorous acid which is a powerful germicide.



Liquid  $\text{Cl}_2$  is most effective when applied to filtered water at such a point where adequate mixing is done.

$\text{Cl}_2$  is the most widely used disinfectant throughout the world.

**Mechanism of action:** Gleen and Stumpt after long experimentation, reported that the death of microorganisms, bacteria etc., result from *chemical action of hypochlorous acid* with the enzymes in the cells of the organisms, etc. since enzyme is essential for the metabolic processes of the microorganisms, so death of microorganisms results due to inactivation of enzyme by hypochlorous acid, producing  $\text{OCl}^-$  which cannot combine with enzymes in the cells of microorganisms.



This explains the fact that chlorine is found to be more effective disinfectant at lower pH values (below 6.5). This is due to the fact that HOCl is about 80 times more destructive to bacteria than  $\text{OCl}^-$ .

The apparatus used for this purpose is known as chlorinator.

**Chlorinator:** it is a high tower having a no. of baffle plates. Water and proper quantity of conc.  $\text{Cl}_2$  treated water is taken out from the bottom. For filtered water about 0.3-0.5 ppm of  $\text{Cl}_2$  is sufficient.

**Factors affecting efficiency of chlorine:**

1. Time of contact: it has been experimentally shown that no. of microorganism destroyed by  $\text{Cl}_2$  per unit time is proportion al to the no. of microorganisms remaining alive. Consequently the death rate is maximum to start with and it goes on decreasing with the time.
2. Temperature of water: the rate of reaction with enzymes increase with temperature. Consequently death rate of microorganism by  $\text{Cl}_2$  increases with rise in water temperature.

3. pH: at lower pH values (5-6.5) a small contact period is required to kill same percentage of organisms.

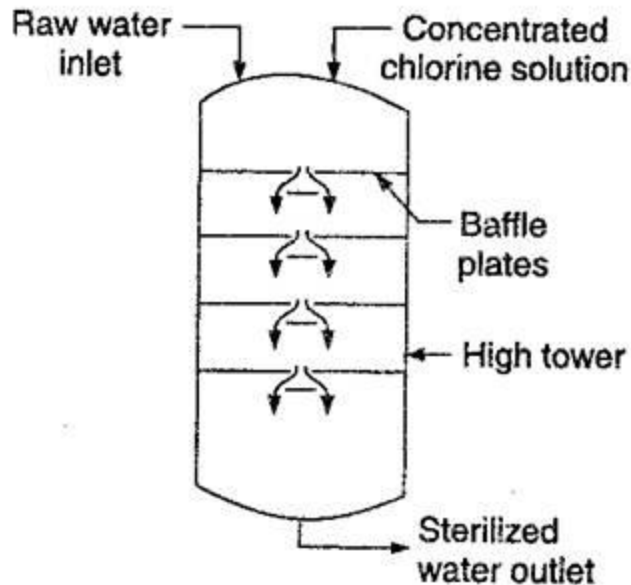
Advantages of chlorine: It is effective and economical, requires little space for storage, stable, used at low and high temperatures and an ideal disinfectant.

Disadvantages: Excess of chlorine if added produces a characteristic unpleasant taste and odour.

It causes irritation on mucus membrane.

The quantity of free chlorine in treated water should not exceed 0.1-0.2 ppm.

It is more effective below 6.5 pH and less effective at higher pH values.



**18Q. Write a short notes on break point chlorination.**

***Break point Chlorination:***

The process of applying calculated amounts of chlorine to water in order to kill the pathogenic bacteria is called chlorination.

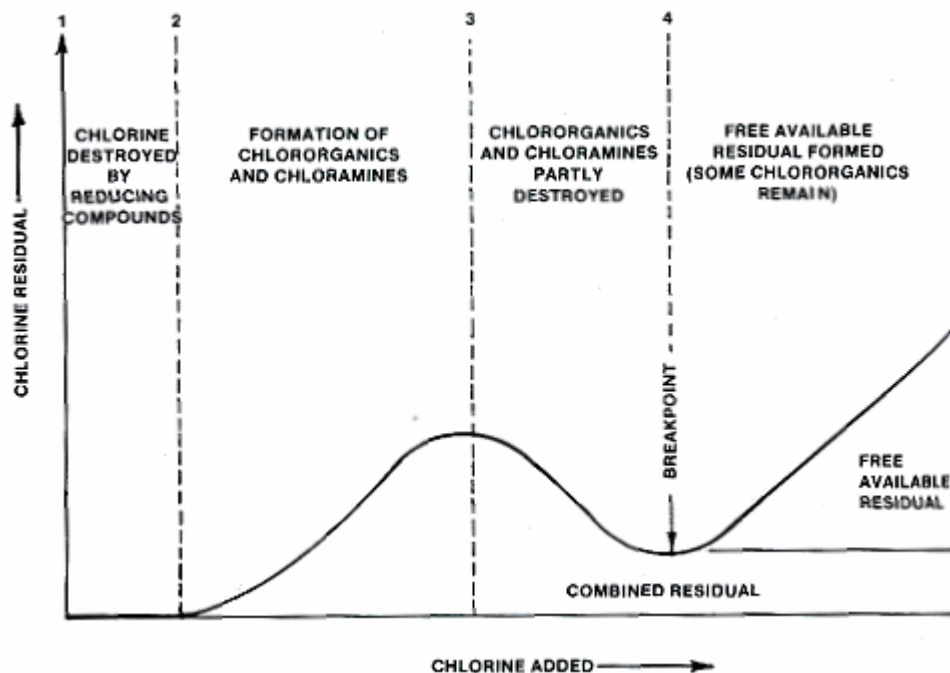
Chlorine also reacts with water and generates hypochlorous acid, which kills bacteria.



Chlorine is a powerful disinfectant than chloramine and bleaching powder. Calculated amount of chlorine must be added to water because chlorine after reaction with bacteria and organic impurities or ammonia, remains in water as residual chlorine which gives bad taste, odour and toxic to human beings.

The amount of chlorine required to kill bacteria and to remove organic matter is called ***break point chlorination***.

The water sample is treated with chlorine and estimated for the residual chlorine in water and plotted as a graph as shown below which gives the break point chlorination.



From the graph it is clear that the area under represents,

1-2 : chlorine added oxidises reducing impurities of water.

2-3: chlorine added forms chloramine and chloro compounds.

3-4: chlorine added causes destruction of bacteria.

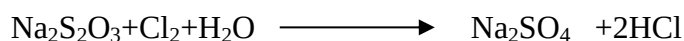
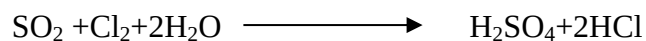
After 4: chlorine is residual chlorine.

So, 4 is the break point for the addition of chlorine to water. This is called break point chlorination.

#### ***Advantages of break point chlorination:***

1. It removes taste, colour, oxidise completely organic compounds, ammonia and other reducing impurities.
2. It destroys completely (100%) all disease producing bacteria.
3. It prevents growth of any weeds in water.
4. De chlorination:

The over chlorination is removed by passing the water through a bed of granular carbon and also by addition of  $\text{SO}_2$  and sodium thiosulphate.





19Q. Write a short notes on sewage and its types.

## 16 WASTE WATER TREATMENT

The main objectives of waste water treatment are :

- (i) To make sewage inoffensive so that it causes no odour,
- (ii) To prevent the destruction of aquatic life in rivers, canals, etc. into which waste water is generally discharged.
- (iii) To reduce or eliminate danger to the public health by possible contamination of water supplies.

Artificial treatment methods are generally used for waste water treatment.

The main features of this method are :

- (a) To reduce the solid contents of the waste water,
- (b) To remove all nuisance-causing elements, and
- (c) To change the character of the waste water so that it safely be discharged in river, sea or applied on land.

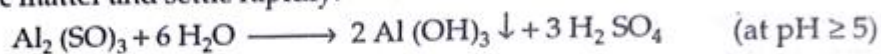
The following steps are generally employed in the artificial sewage treatment :

### (A) Preliminary Process

The preliminary processes cause removal of large and coarse solids and inorganic matter suspended in waste water. The waste water is passed through mesh screens to remove gravels, coarse solids, silt, etc. Moreover, for the removal of large suspended floating matter, the waste water is passed through bar screens.

### (B) Settling Process

The suspended inorganic and organic solids from the waste water are largely removed by settling process. In settling process, continuous flow type sedimentation tanks are employed. Sometimes, prior to sedimentation, chemical treatment is given to waste water. This helps in more rapid and complete removal of suspended matter. Alum, ferrous sulphate etc. are chemicals which are used for chemical treatment. These chemicals can produce large gelatinous flocs, which entrap finely divided organic matter and settle rapidly.

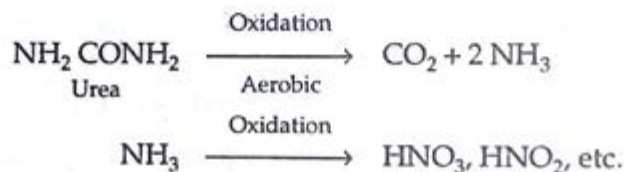


It is important to note that chemical coagulants have the ability to remove colloidal materials.

### (C) Biological Treatment Process

It is essentially a aeration process in which aerobic chemical oxidation takes place. In this process, aerobic conditions are maintained all the times by filtering waste water through specially designed sprinkling filters. During this process, the carbon of the organic matter is converted into  $\text{CO}_2$  ; the nitrogen into  $\text{NH}_3$  and finally into nitrites and nitrates. The dissolved bases, present in the waste water, then form nitrite and nitrate of ammonium, and calcium nitrate etc.

Thus :



In the bottom of bed, the underdrain system is provided to collect affluent. Rotating arm distributions are used for delivering waste water to the filters. As the trickled waste water starts percolating downwards, through the filtering media, micro organism present in waste water grow on the surface of aggregates, using organic material of the sewage as food. Aerobic conditions are maintained and purified water is removed from the bottom. About 90% BOD is removed by normal trickling filters.

### **Activated Sludge Process**

This process is based on the principle that if enough oxygen or air is passed through waste water containing aerobes, slow but complete aerobic oxidation occurs. This oxidation process can be quickened, if this aeration is carried out in the presence of a part of sludge from the previous oxidation process. This sludge is known as *activated sludge* since it contains organic matters inhabited by numerous bacterias, etc.

The activated sludge process consists in mixing the sedimented waste water with proper quantity of activate sludge. This mixture is then sent to the aeration tank, in which the mixed liquor is simultaneously aerated and agitated for 4 to 6 hours. Oxidation of the suspended organic matter takes place during this aeration process. The affluent, after aeration is sent to sedimentation tank. In this tank, sludge is deposited and clean and non-putrefying liquid (*i.e.*, a liquid which is free from bacteria) is drawn off. For seeding fresh batch of sewage, a part of the settled sludge is sent back while the remainder is disposed off by either dumping in sea or spreading uniformly over soil, followed by ploughing in or digestion process.

In this digestion process, the sludge is kept in the absence of air for a prolonged period of about 30 days in a closed tank. The sludge under these conditions suffers anaerobic decomposition yielding gases like methane, hydrogen sulphide, ammonium sulphide and phosphine.

The waste water treatment process is schematically summarized below in Fig. 24.

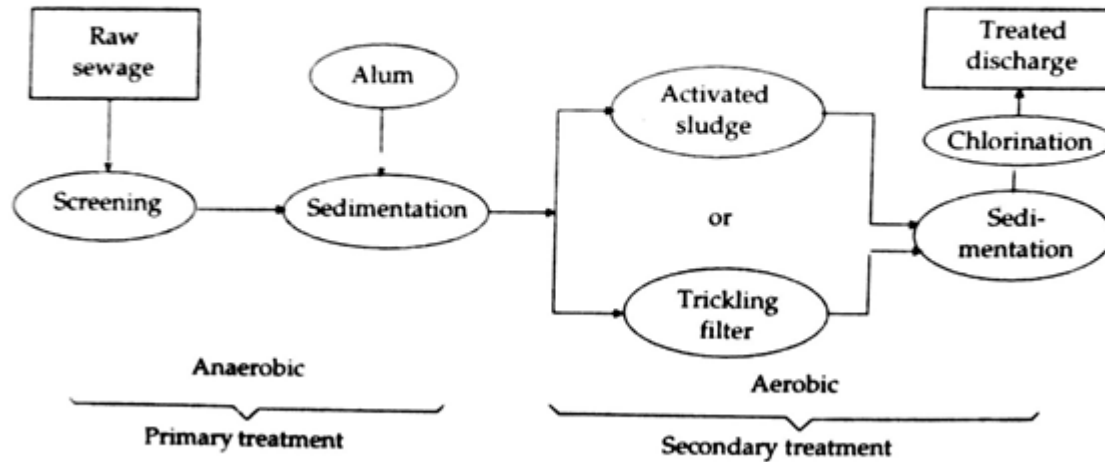


Fig. 24. Flow diagram for sewage treatment

**20Q. What is meant by desalination? Explain the method used for the desalination of brackish water?**

#### **Desalination of brackish water:-**

The process of removing common salt (sodium chloride) from the water is known as “**Desalination**”.

The water containing dissolved salts with a peculiar salty or brackish taste is called “**Brackish water**”.

Ex. Sea water (contains an average of about 3.5% salts) is an example of brackish water.

It is totally unfit for drinking purpose.

Commonly used methods for desalination of brackish water are:-

- 1) Electro dialysis
- 2) Reverse Osmosis

#### **Reverse osmosis:-**

When two solutions of unequal concentrations are separated by a semipermeable membrane (which does not permit selectively the passage of dissolved solute particles i.e., molecules, ions etc) flow of solvent takes place from dilute to concentrated sides, due to Osmosis.

If a hydrostatic pressure in excess of osmotic pressure is applied on the concentrated side, the solvent flow reverses i.e., solvent is forced to move from concentrated side to dilute across the membrane. This is the principle of reverse osmosis.

Thus, in reverse osmosis, pure solvent (water) is separated from its contaminants, rather than removing contaminants from water. This membrane filtration is also called “**Super/ Hyper filtration**”.

**Method:**

In this process, pressure ( $15\text{--}40\text{ kg/cm}^2$ ) is applied to sea water/impure water (to be treated) to force its pure water through the semi-permeable; leaving behind the dissolved solids (both ionic and non-ionic). The principle of reverse osmosis as applied for treating saline/sea water is as follows: given in fig above.

The membrane consists of very thin film of cellulose acetate, affixed to either side of a perforated tube. Superior membranes recently developed are made of polymethacrylate and polyamide polymers have come into use.

**Advantages:**

- 1) Reverse osmosis process has distinct advantage of removing ionic as well as non-ionic, colloidal and high molecular weight organic matter.
- 2) It removes colloidal silica, which is not removed by demineralization.
- 3) The life time of membrane is quite high, about 2 years.
- 4) The membrane can be replaced within a few minutes thereby providing nearly uninterrupted water supply.
- 5) Low capital cost, simplicity, low operating cost and high reliability.
- 6) The reverse osmosis is gaining ground at present for converting sea water into drinking water and for obtaining water for very high pressure boilers.

